

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

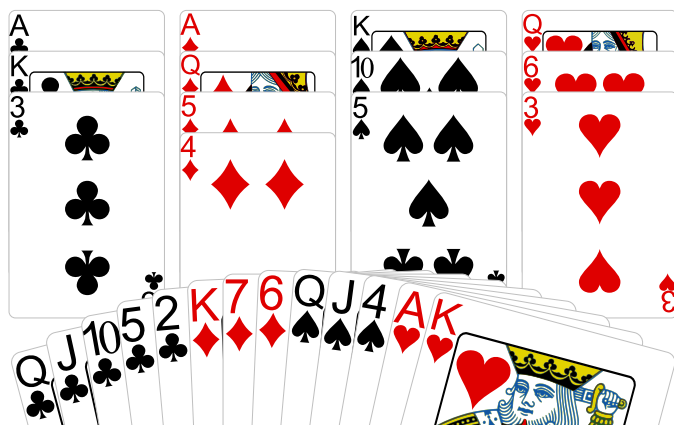
- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



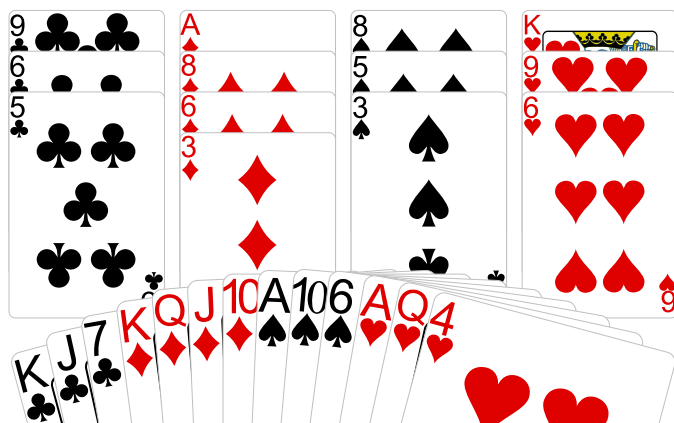
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Deal 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 6 2
♥ 8 4
♦ J T 3
♣ 8 7 6

16
5 1
18

♠ Q J 4
♥ A K
♦ K 7 6
♣ Q J T 5 2



♠ K T 5
♥ Q 6 3
♦ A Q 5 4
♣ A K 3

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♠ 7 3
♥ J T 9 7 5 2
♦ 9 8 2
♣ 9 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	6NT
Pass			
6NT by North			

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 7 4
♥ Q J 5
♦ K J T
♣ A 7 4 3

4
14 21
1

♠ A 6 3 2
♥ T 6 4 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 9 6 5



♠ T 8 5
♥ 9 7 2
♦ 9 7 6 4
♣ J T 2

♠ Q J 9
♥ A K 8
♦ A Q 5 3
♣ K Q 8

West

North

East
2NT

South
Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

GOES

to 6NT.

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The partner who is first sure what the final contract should be should just go ahead and bid it.

This is called "She who knows, goes."

In this deal, for example, it is WEST who knows. She has a balanced 14 points, so when EAST indicates

20/21 points with his opening 2NT bid she

KNOWS

the partnership holds about 34/35 points.

Therefore she

Deal 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 9 4
♥ T 7 2
♦ 5 4
♣ Q 8 4

7
8 5
20

♠ 8 5 3
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 6 5



♠ A T 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ K Q J T
♣ K J 7

♠ 7 2
♥ J 8 5 3
♦ 9 7 2
♣ A T 3 2

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SOUTH has a balanced 20 point hand - ideal to open 2NT.

NORTH has 7 points; he knows the partnership has either 27 or 28 points so he bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Deal 4

West Deals
Both Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ T 7 4 3
♦ A 9 8 2
♣ K Q

4
16 17
3

West
1NT
All Pass
6NT by West
to 6NT.

♠ T 9 3 2
♥ Q J 9 5
♦ J 7 6
♣ 6 3



♠ Q J 8
♥ 6 2
♦ T 5 4 3
♣ 9 8 5 2

North
Pass

East
6NT

South

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This is another example of "She who knows, goes."

EAST has a solid 18 points, (1 extra for the fifth Club), so when WEST opens 1NT

she

KNOWS

that together they must hold at least 33 points.
The may even have 35 points.

In any case they should be in slam, so EAST

GOES

Deal 5

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8 5 2
♥ 6 3 2
♦ T 8 4 2
♣ A J

19
9 6
6

♠ K J 9
♥ A Q
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ K T 4



♠ T 6 3
♥ T 8 5
♦ A 7 3
♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ Q 7 4
♥ K J 9 7 4
♦ 6
♣ 7 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

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NORTH has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT.

(20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

Deal 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q T 3
 ♥ K T 6
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ T 7 5 2

7
 9 16
 8

♠ 7 6 4
 ♥ 5 4 3
 ♦ K 6 5 2
 ♣ A 9 6

N
 W E
 S

♠ A 8 5
 ♥ Q J 7 2
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ 8 4 3

♠ K J 9 2
 ♥ A 9 8
 ♦ Q T 8
 ♣ K Q J

West

Pass

2NT

All Pass

3NT by East

North

Pass

Pass

East

1NT

3NT

South

Pass

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After WEST passes initially, EAST opens 1NT.

With 9 points, WEST has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

EAST has a small problem - WEST's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass

with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points

she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.